What Makes a Good Day? A Worksheet for Your Wife's Ordinary Day, in Her Words

Write down her day the way she tells it, and mark what you filled in yourself.

You could describe your wife's morning in your sleep. It has just never needed to be on paper, and her own account of it may not match yours in every detail.

Sit with her when she's rested and ask open questions, the kind that can't be answered with a yes or a no. Write what she says, the way she says it. Ten minutes is plenty for one sitting, and you can come back to it tomorrow.

Where she doesn't answer, write what you know and list it in the fifth box, so it stays marked as yours.

A good day, in her words

Ask her what a good day looks like, then write what she says. Keep her phrasing, even where you'd put it differently.

FOR EXAMPLE “Tea first, before anybody talks to me. Then the crossword. A good day is one where nobody hurries me.”

Her mornings and evenings

From waking until the day is under way, and from supper until she's asleep, in the order things happen.

FOR EXAMPLE Up around seven. Tea, milk and no sugar, in the blue mug, before she dresses. Radio on in the kitchen. Evenings: the news at six, then she phones her sister.

Meals, as she likes them

What she likes to eat and drink, what she doesn't, and when she usually eats. Likes and dislikes only. Allergies and anything a clinician has told you about her diet go on a separate sheet, not here.

FOR EXAMPLE “I don't eat fish. Never have.” Main meal at midday, something light around six.

What she enjoys, and who matters to her

The things she'd miss if they stopped, and the people she'd want to see or hear from.

FOR EXAMPLE “Thursdays are for Ruth.” The garden, even just to sit in it. The crossword after breakfast.

What I filled in myself

Go back over the page and list anything that came from you and not from her. It isn't wrong. It just hasn't been checked with her yet.

FOR EXAMPLE The bedroom door left open a little at night: that one is mine. I haven't asked her.

Who filled this in, and on which day

What this shows you

Two things: her ordinary day as she tells it, and the parts that are still your account and not yet hers. It isn't everything a new team will want to know about her, nothing here adds up to a score, and none of it is an instruction for her care. Allergies, dietary instructions and anything medical stay with the clinicians who gave them.

Ready for the next step?

You've put her ordinary day on paper in her words, with your own additions marked. The care interview picks up from there: it asks about her preferences across every part of the day, alongside her care needs and the people who support her, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›